When the reporting or principal verb is in the Past Tense, all Present tenses of the Direct are changed into the corresponding Past Tenses. Thus:-

(a) A simple present becomes a simple past.

Direct - He said, "I am fine."
Indirect - He said (that) he was fine.

(b) A present continuous becomes a past continuous.

Direct - She said, "My sister is learning Karate."
Indirect - She said (that) her sister was learning Karate.

(c) A present perfect becomes a past perfect.

Direct - He said, "I have won the match."
Indirect - He said (that) he had won the match.

(d) The 'shall' and the 'will' of the Future Tense is changed into should and would.

(e) The simple past in the Direct becomes the past perfect in the Indirect.

Direct - She said, "The horse died in the night."
Indirect - She said that the horse had died in the night.

(f) The tenses may not change if the statement is a universal truth.

Direct - The teacher said, "The earth goes round the sun."
Indirect - The teacher said the earth goes round the sun.

(g) If the reporting verb is in the Present Tense, the tenses of the Direct Speech do not change.

For example, we may rewrite the above examples, by writing the reporting verb in the Present Tense like:

He says he is fine.
She has just said her sister is learning Bharatanatyam.
He says he has won the match.
She says the horse died in the night.

8th_english_4 to 6.indd 165 16-12-2022 14:25:39